1.1 Introduction

In class VI, we studied how to compare and arrange integers. Now, let us try to add and subtract integers.

We know 7–5 = 2. But, what is 5–7? Let us try to take away 7 from 5 using the number line. As the integers on the number line increases from left to right, we should move to the left of zero to do this subtraction.

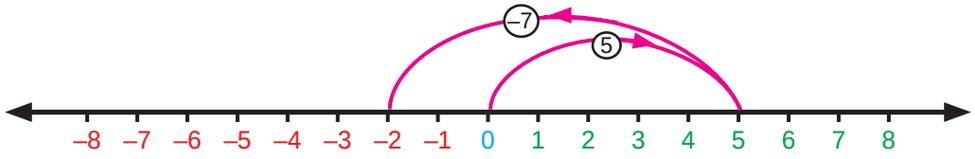
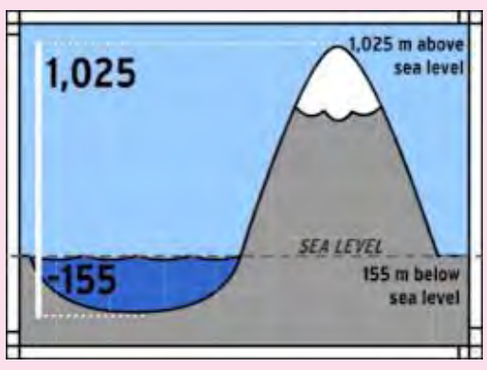


Fig. 1.3

Is it really necessary to do this? Have you come across any such situations in life? Yes, there are situations like increase or decrease in temperature, amount deposited and withdrawn from an account, profit and loss in a business are all instances where integers are involved.

MATHEMATICS ALIVE – NUMBER SYSTEM IN REAL LIFE



Mountain, below and above sea level.



Termperature is < 0°C in Antarctica and Arctic, >0°C in Equator.

1.2 Addition of Integers

The number line is a simple tool to visualise addition of integers. Let us do an activity with the number line.

Imagine that the number line is a road with markers on it. We are allowed to step forward or backward on this road. One step taken is equal to one unit of number. Initially we start at zero and face positive direction. We step forward for positive integers and backward for negative integers. We maintain the same positive direction for addition operation.

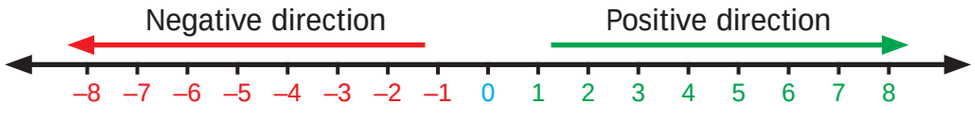


Fig. 1.4

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